

BOARD OF INTERMEDIATE AND SECONDARY EDUCATION

Annual Examination 2026

Mathematics — SSC-I (9th Grade)

Syllabus: Chapter 6 — Trigonometry and Bearing

ANSWER KEY (Version 1)

Total Marks: 65

Time Allowed: 2h 30m

Version: 1

SECTION A — MCQ Answer Key ($12 \times 1 = 12$ Marks)

1

Answer: B — 60 1 mark

By definition, $1^\circ = 60'$ (minutes). There are **3600 seconds** in a degree, not minutes. Distractor D (3600) is the seconds conversion, a common mix-up.

2

Answer: B — 2π radians 1 mark

The **circumference-to-radius ratio** of a full circle is 2π , so a complete rotation = 2π radians. π radians corresponds to only a half circle (180°).

3

Answer: C — $l = r\theta$ 1 mark

Arc length = radius $\times$ central angle in radians. This follows from the proportionality **$l : \theta :: r : 1$** , giving $l = r\theta$. θ must be in radians.

4

Answer: B — $1/2$ 1 mark

In a 30-60-90 triangle, the side opposite 30° is **half the hypotenuse**, so $\sin 30^\circ = 1/2$. Option A ($\sqrt{3}/2$) is $\sin 60^\circ$, a frequent confusion.

5

Answer: C — $\sin\theta$ 1 mark

In the **second quadrant** $x < 0$, $y > 0$. Since $\sin\theta = y/r$ with r always positive, $\sin\theta > 0$. $\cos\theta < 0$ ($x < 0$) and $\tan\theta < 0$ ($y/x = \text{positive/negative}$).

6

Answer: C — $\sin^2\theta + \cos^2\theta = 1$ 1 mark

The **fundamental Pythagorean identity**. Dividing $a^2 + b^2 = c^2$ by c^2 gives this. Option B should be $\sec^2\theta - \tan^2\theta = 1$ (not plus), making it wrong.

7

Answer: B — Base / Hyp 1 mark

$\cos\theta = \text{Base/Hypotenuse} = b/c$. The base is the side adjacent to angle θ and the hypotenuse is the longest side.

8

Answer: D — 50.5° 1 mark

$50^\circ 30' = 50^\circ + (30/60)^\circ = 50^\circ + 0.5^\circ = \mathbf{50.5^\circ}$. This is a direct application of $D^\circ M'$ to decimal conversion from the Miscellaneous Exercise.

9

Answer: B — Angle of elevation 1 mark

Angle of elevation is formed when the object is above the horizontal line of sight. Angle of depression applies when the object is below.

Answer: C — North 1 mark

Bearings are measured **clockwise from north** and expressed as three-figure numbers (000° to 360°). North itself has bearing 000° .

Answer: C — 090° 1 mark

From the Key Points: north = 000° , **east = 090°** , south = 180° , west = 270° . East is a quarter-turn clockwise from north.

Answer: B — 45° 1 mark

$\cos x = \sin x$ implies $\tan x = 1$, so **$x = 45^\circ$** . At 45° the right triangle is isosceles (base = perpendicular), making sin and cos equal (both = $1/\sqrt{2}$). From Miscellaneous Exercise Q(v).

SECTION B — Short Questions Answer Key ($11 \times 3 = 33$ Marks)

2(i) — Convert $45^\circ 45' 45''$ into seconds 3 marks

$$45^\circ 45' 45'' = 45^\circ + 45' + 45''$$

$$= (45 \times 3600)'' + (45 \times 60)'' + 45''$$
 1 mark

$$= 162000'' + 2700'' + 45''$$
 1 mark

$$= \mathbf{164745''}$$
 1 mark

OR — Convert 216000'' into $D^\circ M'S''$

$$216000'' = (216000 / 60)' = 3600'$$
 1 mark

$$3600' = (3600 / 60)^\circ = 60^\circ$$
 1 mark

$$= \mathbf{60^\circ 0' 0''}$$
 1 mark

2(ii) — Convert 45° into radians 3 marks

To convert degrees to radians, multiply by $\pi/180$.

$$45^\circ = 45 \times (\pi/180) \text{ radians}$$
 1 mark

$$= \pi/4 \text{ radians}$$
 1 mark

$$\approx \mathbf{0.7854 \text{ radians}}$$
 1 mark

OR — Convert $3\pi/4$ radians into $D^\circ M'S''$

$$3\pi/4 = (3/4) \times (180/\pi)^\circ = (3/4) \times 180^\circ = 135^\circ$$
 1 mark

$$= 135^\circ + 0' + 0''$$
 1 mark

$$= \mathbf{135^\circ 0' 0''}$$
 1 mark

2(iii) — Arc length and area of sector: $r = 12$ m, $\theta = 120^\circ$ 3 marks

$$\text{Convert: } \theta = 120^\circ = 120 \times (\pi/180) = 2\pi/3 \text{ rad}$$
 1 mark

$$\text{Arc length } l = r\theta = 12 \times 2\pi/3 = 8\pi \text{ m} \approx 25.13 \text{ m}$$
 1 mark

$$\text{Area } A = \frac{1}{2}r^2\theta = \frac{1}{2}(144)(2\pi/3) = 48\pi \text{ m}^2 \approx 150.80 \text{ m}^2$$
 1 mark

OR — 30-inch pendulum, angle 30°

$$\text{Convert: } 30^\circ = 30 \times (\pi/180) = \pi/6 \text{ rad}$$
 1 mark

$$l = r\theta = 30 \times \pi/6 = 5\pi \text{ inches}$$
 1 mark

$$\approx 5 \times 3.1416 \approx 15.71 \text{ inches}$$
 1 mark

2(iv) — Six trig ratios given $\sin\theta = \sqrt{3}/2$, first quadrant 3 marks

$\sin\theta = \sqrt{3}/2$, so perpendicular = $\sqrt{3}$, hypotenuse = 2. By Pythagoras: base = $\sqrt{4-3} = 1$. 1 mark

$\sin\theta = \sqrt{3}/2$ | $\cos\theta = 1/2$ | $\tan\theta = \sqrt{3}$ 1 mark

$\operatorname{cosec}\theta = 2/\sqrt{3}$ | $\sec\theta = 2$ | $\cot\theta = 1/\sqrt{3}$ 1 mark

OR — Six trig ratios of 45°

At 45° : base = perpendicular = 1, hypotenuse = $\sqrt{2}$. 1 mark

$\sin 45^\circ = 1/\sqrt{2}$, $\cos 45^\circ = 1/\sqrt{2}$, $\tan 45^\circ = 1$ 1 mark

$\operatorname{cosec} 45^\circ = \sqrt{2}$, $\sec 45^\circ = \sqrt{2}$, $\cot 45^\circ = 1$ 1 mark

2(v) — Evaluate $\sin 60^\circ - \cos 30^\circ$ 3 marks

$\sin 60^\circ = \sqrt{3}/2$ 1 mark

$\cos 30^\circ = \sqrt{3}/2$ 1 mark

$\sin 60^\circ - \cos 30^\circ = \sqrt{3}/2 - \sqrt{3}/2 = 0$ 1 mark

OR — $\sec 45^\circ \operatorname{cosec} 45^\circ - \sin 30^\circ \cos 60^\circ$

$\sec 45^\circ = \sqrt{2}$, $\operatorname{cosec} 45^\circ = \sqrt{2}$, $\sin 30^\circ = 1/2$, $\cos 60^\circ = 1/2$ 1 mark

$= (\sqrt{2})(\sqrt{2}) - (1/2)(1/2) = 2 - 1/4$ 1 mark

$= 7/4 = 1.75$ 1 mark

2(vi) — $\cos\theta = 1/2$, terminal ray in first quadrant, find remaining ratios 3 marks

$\cos\theta = 1/2 \Rightarrow$ base = 1, hyp = 2. Perp = $\sqrt{4-1} = \sqrt{3}$. 1 mark

$\sin\theta = \sqrt{3}/2$, $\tan\theta = \sqrt{3}$ 1 mark

$\operatorname{cosec}\theta = 2/\sqrt{3}$, $\sec\theta = 2$, $\cot\theta = 1/\sqrt{3}$ 1 mark

OR — $\operatorname{cosec}\theta = 2$, second quadrant; find $\cos\theta \cdot (\sin^2\theta - \cos^2\theta)/(\sin^2\theta + \cos^2\theta)$

$\operatorname{cosec}\theta = 2 \Rightarrow \sin\theta = 1/2$. In Q2: $\cos\theta = -\sqrt{3}/2$. 1 mark

$\sin^2\theta + \cos^2\theta = 1$ (denominator). Numerator: $1/4 - 3/4 = -1/2$. 1 mark

$= (-\sqrt{3}/2) \times (-1/2) = \sqrt{3}/4$ 1 mark

2(vii) — Prove: $(1 - \sin^2\theta) \sec^2\theta = 1$ 3 marks

L.H.S. = $(1 - \sin^2\theta) \sec^2\theta$ 1 mark

Use identity: $1 - \sin^2\theta = \cos^2\theta$ 1 mark

$= \cos^2\theta \times (1/\cos^2\theta) = 1 = \text{R.H.S.}$ Hence proved. 1 mark

OR — Prove: $1/(\sec\theta - \tan\theta) = \sec\theta + \tan\theta$

L.H.S. = $1/(\sec\theta - \tan\theta)$. Multiply numerator and denominator by $(\sec\theta + \tan\theta)$: 1 mark

$= (\sec\theta + \tan\theta) / (\sec^2\theta - \tan^2\theta)$ 1 mark

$= (\sec\theta + \tan\theta) / 1 = \sec\theta + \tan\theta = \text{R.H.S.}$ Hence proved. 1 mark

2(viii) — Solve triangle ABC: $\angle C = 90^\circ$, $\angle A = 30^\circ$, $a = 6$ cm 3 marks

$\angle A + \angle B + \angle C = 180^\circ \Rightarrow 30^\circ + \angle B + 90^\circ = 180^\circ \Rightarrow \angle B = 60^\circ$ 1 mark

$\sin 30^\circ = a/c \Rightarrow 1/2 = 6/c \Rightarrow c = 12$ cm 1 mark

$b^2 = c^2 - a^2 = 144 - 36 = 108 \Rightarrow b = 6\sqrt{3}$ cm 1 mark

OR — Triangle PQR: $\angle Q = 90^\circ$, $\angle P = 60^\circ$, $PQ = 4\sqrt{3}$ cm

$\angle P + \angle R = 90^\circ \Rightarrow \angle R = 30^\circ$ 1 mark

$\tan 60^\circ = QR/PQ \Rightarrow \sqrt{3} = QR/(4\sqrt{3}) \Rightarrow QR = 12$ cm 1 mark

$PR = PQ/\cos 60^\circ = (4\sqrt{3})/(1/2) = 8\sqrt{3}$ cm 1 mark

2(ix) — Angle of elevation 30° from 20 m distance 3 marks

Let height of tree = h. In right triangle: $\tan 30^\circ = h/20$ 1 mark

$$1/\sqrt{3} = h/20 \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

$$h = 20/\sqrt{3} = (20\sqrt{3})/3 \approx 11.55 \text{ m} \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

OR — Shadow $10\sqrt{3}$ m, pole 10 m high

$$\tan \alpha = \text{opposite/adjacent} = \text{height/shadow} = 10/(10\sqrt{3}) \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

$$\tan \alpha = 1/\sqrt{3} \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

$$\alpha = 30^\circ \text{ — angle of elevation of the sun} \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

2(x) — Definition of bearing and cardinal bearings 3 marks

Bearing: the angle measured clockwise from north, expressed as a three-digit number. 1 mark

$$\text{North} = 000^\circ, \text{East} = 090^\circ \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

$$\text{South} = 180^\circ, \text{West} = 270^\circ \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

OR — Bearing of A from B if bearing of B from A = 250°

$$\text{Since } 250^\circ > 180^\circ, \text{ use: bearing of A from B} = \text{bearing of B from A} - 180^\circ \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

$$= 250^\circ - 180^\circ \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

$$= 070^\circ \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

2(xi) — Car travels 040° for 13 km; find northward and eastward distances 3 marks

Bearing 040° means angle of 40° clockwise from north, so the triangle has north-component and east-component. 1 mark

$$\text{Northward} = 13 \cos 40^\circ \approx 13 \times 0.766 \approx 9.96 \text{ km} \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

$$\text{Eastward} = 13 \sin 40^\circ \approx 13 \times 0.643 \approx 8.36 \text{ km} \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

OR — Plane 119 km west, 100 km south; find bearing to airport

The plane must fly north-east to reach airport. $\tan \theta = 119/100 \Rightarrow \theta = \tan^{-1}(1.19) \approx 49.96^\circ \approx 50^\circ$ (east of north) 1 mark

Since airport is to the north-east of the plane: 1 mark

$$\text{Bearing} = 000^\circ + 50^\circ = 050^\circ \text{ (approximately)} \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

SECTION C — Long Questions Answer Key ($4 \times 5 = 20$ Marks)

3(i) — Arc length, sector area and central angle: $r=6$ dm, $\theta=60^\circ 45' 30''$ 5 marks

Step 1: Convert θ to decimal degrees. 1 mark

$$60^\circ 45' 30'' = 60 + 45/60 + 30/3600 = 60 + 0.75 + 0.00833 = 60.7583^\circ$$

Step 2: Convert to radians. 1 mark

$$\theta = 60.7583 \times \pi/180 \approx 60.7583 \times 0.01745 \approx 1.0603 \text{ rad}$$

Step 3: Arc length $l = r\theta = 6 \times 1.0603 \approx 6.36$ dm 1 mark

Step 4: Area $A = \frac{1}{2}r^2\theta = \frac{1}{2} \times 36 \times 1.0603 \approx 19.09$ dm² 1 mark

Verification: $A = \frac{1}{2} \times r \times l = \frac{1}{2} \times 6 \times 6.36 = 19.08$ dm² $\approx$ same (rounding) — verified. 1 mark

OR — $l = 4$ cm, $A = 16$ cm²; find r and θ

Step 1: From $l = r\theta$, we get $\theta = l/r = 4/r$. 1 mark

Step 2: Substitute into $A = \frac{1}{2}r^2\theta$: 1 mark

$$16 = \frac{1}{2} \times r^2 \times (4/r) = 2r$$

Step 3: $r = 8$ cm 1 mark

Step 4: $\theta = l/r = 4/8 = 0.5$ rad = $1/2$ radian 1 mark

Check: $A = \frac{1}{2} \times 64 \times 0.5 = 16$ cm² — correct. 1 mark

3(ii) — Prove two trigonometric identities 5 marks**Identity (a):** $(\sin\theta - 2\sin^3\theta) / (2\cos^3\theta - \cos\theta) = \tan\theta$ 2 marks

$$\text{L.H.S.} = \sin\theta(1 - 2\sin^2\theta) / \cos\theta(2\cos^2\theta - 1)$$

Use: $1 - 2\sin^2\theta = 2\cos^2\theta - 1$ (both equal $\cos 2\theta$ form; or note they are equal via $\sin^2 + \cos^2 = 1$)
 $= \sin\theta(1 - 2\sin^2\theta) / \cos\theta(1 - 2\sin^2\theta) = \sin\theta/\cos\theta = \tan\theta = \text{R.H.S.}$ Hence proved.

Identity (b): $\sqrt{(\sec^2\theta + \operatorname{cosec}^2\theta)} = \tan\theta + \cot\theta$ 3 marks

$$\text{R.H.S.} = \tan\theta + \cot\theta = \sin\theta/\cos\theta + \cos\theta/\sin\theta = (\sin^2\theta + \cos^2\theta)/(\sin\theta\cos\theta) = 1/(\sin\theta\cos\theta)$$

$$\text{L.H.S.} = \sqrt{(1/\cos^2\theta + 1/\sin^2\theta)} = \sqrt{((\sin^2\theta + \cos^2\theta)/(\sin^2\theta\cos^2\theta))} = \sqrt{(1/(\sin^2\theta\cos^2\theta))} = 1/(\sin\theta\cos\theta)$$

L.H.S. = R.H.S. — Hence proved.**OR — Prove two OR identities****Identity (a):** $(1 - \sin\theta)/(1 + \sin\theta) = (\sec\theta - \tan\theta)^2$ 2 marks

$$\text{R.H.S.} = (1/\cos\theta - \sin\theta/\cos\theta)^2 = ((1 - \sin\theta)/\cos\theta)^2 = (1 - \sin\theta)^2/\cos^2\theta$$

$$= (1 - \sin\theta)^2/(1 - \sin^2\theta) = (1 - \sin\theta)^2/((1 - \sin\theta)(1 + \sin\theta)) = (1 - \sin\theta)/(1 + \sin\theta) = \text{L.H.S.}$$

Identity (b): $\sin^6\theta + \cos^6\theta = 1 - 3\sin^2\theta\cos^2\theta$ 3 marksUse $a^3 + b^3 = (a+b)(a^2 - ab + b^2)$ with $a = \sin^2\theta$, $b = \cos^2\theta$:

$$= (\sin^2\theta + \cos^2\theta)(\sin^4\theta - \sin^2\theta\cos^2\theta + \cos^4\theta)$$

$$= 1 \times ((\sin^2\theta + \cos^2\theta)^2 - 3\sin^2\theta\cos^2\theta) = 1 - 3\sin^2\theta\cos^2\theta = \text{R.H.S.} \text{ Hence proved.}$$

3(iii) — Aeroplane at 900 m altitude, angles of depression 30° and 60° 5 marks**Step 1:** Let C be the point directly below O. Let $BC = y$ (nearer ship) and $AC = x$ (farther ship). 1 mark**Step 2:** In right triangle OCB (angle of depression 60° means $\angle OBC = 60^\circ$ by alternate angles): 1 mark

$$\tan 60^\circ = OC/BC \Rightarrow \sqrt{3} = 900/y \Rightarrow y = 900/\sqrt{3} = 300\sqrt{3} \approx 519.62 \text{ m}$$

Step 3: In right triangle OCA (angle of depression 30°, $\angle OAC = 30^\circ$): 1 mark

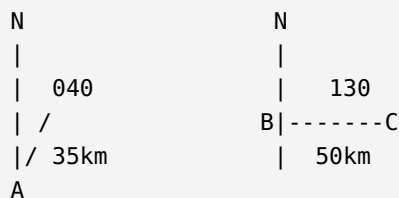
$$\tan 30^\circ = 900/x \Rightarrow 1/\sqrt{3} = 900/x \Rightarrow x = 900\sqrt{3} \approx 1558.85 \text{ m}$$

Step 4: Distance between ships $= AB = AC - BC = x - y$ 1 mark

$$= 900\sqrt{3} - 300\sqrt{3} = 600\sqrt{3} \approx 1039.23 \text{ m} \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

OR — Tower 120 m, depression angles 60° and 45°**Step 1:** Let T be top of tower (height 120 m). Let A and B be the two boats, B nearer. 1 mark**Step 2:** $\tan 60^\circ = 120/TB \Rightarrow \sqrt{3} = 120/TB \Rightarrow TB = 120/\sqrt{3} = 40\sqrt{3} \text{ m}$ 1 mark**Step 3:** $\tan 45^\circ = 120/TA \Rightarrow 1 = 120/TA \Rightarrow TA = 120 \text{ m}$ 1 mark**Step 4:** Distance $AB = TA - TB = 120 - 40\sqrt{3}$ 1 mark

$$= 120 - 69.28 \approx 50.72 \text{ m} \quad 1 \text{ mark}$$

3(iv) — Ship A to B (040°, 35 km) then B to C (130°, 50 km) 5 marks**Step 1:** Angle at B between AB and BC directions. **1 mark**

The two north lines at A and B are parallel. Bearing AB = 040°, bearing BC = 130°.

Angle between AB extended and BC = 130° − 040° = 90°. So triangle ABC has a right angle at B.

Step 2 (a) — Find AC: By Pythagoras: **1 mark**

$$AC = \sqrt{AB^2 + BC^2} = \sqrt{35^2 + 50^2} = \sqrt{1225 + 2500} = \sqrt{3725} \approx \mathbf{61.03 \text{ km}} \quad \mathbf{1 \text{ mark}}$$

Step 3 (b) — Find bearing of C from A: **1 mark**

$$\tan \alpha = BC/AB = 50/35 \approx 1.4286 \Rightarrow \alpha = \tan^{-1}(1.4286) \approx 55^\circ$$

$$\mathbf{\text{Bearing of C from A} = 040^\circ + 055^\circ = 095^\circ} \quad \mathbf{1 \text{ mark}}$$

OR — P to Q (050°, 3 km), Q to R (140°), PR = 5 km**Step 1:** Angle PQR: bearing PQ=050°, bearing QR=140°. Angle at Q = 140°−050°=90°. Right angle at Q.**1 mark**

$$\mathbf{\text{Step 2 (a):}} \quad QR = \sqrt{PR^2 - PQ^2} = \sqrt{25 - 9} = \sqrt{16} = \mathbf{4 \text{ km}} \quad \mathbf{1 \text{ mark}}$$

Step 3 (b) bearing of R from P: **1 mark**

$$\tan \alpha = QR/PQ = 4/3 \Rightarrow \alpha = \tan^{-1}(4/3) \approx 53.13^\circ \quad \mathbf{1 \text{ mark}}$$

$$\mathbf{\text{Bearing of R from P} = 050^\circ + 053^\circ = 103^\circ} \quad \mathbf{1 \text{ mark}}$$